‘Learn the value of Karma from our scriptures. It will teach you that you need to have dedication and devotion. Leave everything else to God,’ he wrote.

These communications were frequent and during the course of the investigation, senior officers were intrigued to discover that Rabinder Singh always wore a mask.

‘The evidence collected from his two personal laptops shows he lived a very conflicting and complicated life. We tried to find out more on Jeffrey from one of our assets in USA, but it was a cover name and we realised there was no such officer posted at Langley. However, Annie’s details were procured and shipped to the Indian agency to corroborate the events leading to India’s biggest spy scandal,’ said Vijay Nambiar, a R&AW officer.

Were R&AW officials knowingly passing information to Rabinder Singh? According to an officer codenamed K.K. Sharma, in the course of surveillance on Rabinder Singh between January 2004 and April 2004, more than fifty-five officers of the agency were discovered to have inadvertently supplied intelligence and documents to the double agent. It was a trap laid by Rabinder, Sharma said, to innocent officials to feed him with intelligence and analysis on immediate neighbours such as the growing relationship between Myanmar and China, the Naxal penetration in Nepal, how the Taliban operated in Afghanistan, the activities of the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) in Sri Lanka and their illegal procurement of weapons with the help of arms dealers in Eastern Europe.

I asked Sharma: ‘How does it feel when you know there is a traitor working with you in the organisation, a person who is passing on intelligence that could compromise the lives of hundreds of agents working abroad?’